

Daily Current Affairs — Class Notes

Session Date: 26 August 2026 | Compiled from Morning Live Class

1. India's First Non-GMO Popcorn Maize Variety

India's first Non-GMO (Non-Genetically Modified Organism) popcorn maize variety was launched in **Andhra Pradesh**. GMO means a crop developed through genetic/hybrid modification technology; a Non-GMO variety, by contrast, is developed **without** any hybridisation process, through conventional plant-breeding techniques.

Developed by	Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) and the Indian Institute of Maize Research (IIMR)
ICAR Headquarters	New Delhi (established 1929)
IIMR Headquarters	Ludhiana, Punjab
Launch venue	Musunuru village, Eluru district, Andhra Pradesh
Institute at launch site	Government (Govt.) Agricultural Research Institute, Musunuru
Launched in presence of	Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan and Andhra Pradesh CM N. Chandrababu Naidu
Key feature	Elongated / larger kernel size compared to normal popcorn maize

Related background facts:

- India's first GM (genetically modified) crop was **Bt Cotton**.
- Ideal climatic conditions for maize: warm climate, temperature range 21°C–27°C, moderate rainfall of 50–100 cm.
- Karnataka is the leading maize-producing state in India.
- Andhra Pradesh was the first state formed on a linguistic basis (1953); it was reorganised as a state again under the States Reorganisation Act, 1956.

2. KAVACH — Automatic Train Protection (ATP) System

Kavach is India's indigenously developed Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system, designed to ensure railway safety by preventing train collisions. Kavach 4.0 has recently been rolled out, and the technology is already deployed on Vande Bharat trains.

- Purpose: Automatic Train Protection — prevents collision by automatically applying brakes.
- Currently deployed/being expanded on Vande Bharat Express routes.
- Developed indigenously to enhance overall railway safety standards in India.

3. NSG's First All-Women Commando Course (Black Cat Commandos)

The **National Security Guard (NSG)**, popularly known as the '**Black Cat Commandos**', has launched India's first All-Women Commando Course, aimed at preparing women personnel for future induction into NSG counter-terrorism operations.

Formed on	16 October 1984
Formed after	Operation Blue Star, Golden Temple, Amritsar (shortly before Indira Gandhi's assassination)
Ministry	Ministry of Home Affairs
Nickname	Black Cat Commandos
Course launch venue	Manesar, Haryana

Course duration	About 12 weeks
Course focus	Anti-terrorism training (also covers anti-hijacking, anti-terror operations)
Eligibility	Personnel already selected from CRPF / State Police forces, chosen for this specialised training
NSG Training Centre	Gurugram, Haryana
Current NSG Chief (Head)	Mr. Srinivasan, IPS officer

Gurugram fact file:

- Home to the world's only Green ATM as well as an LPG ATM.
- Houses the Headquarters of the International Solar Alliance (ISA) — the only headquarters of a fully international-level organisation located in India.

4. Chinook Wind (Foehn-type Local Wind)

The question referred to a local, dry, warm wind of the Foehn type that blows down the eastern slopes of the **Rocky Mountains** in North America. The correct answer is **Chinook**.

- Chinook is also known as the '**Snow Eater**' because it rapidly melts snow on the plains.
- It is analogous to the Foehn wind of the Alps in Europe.

5. Nafithromycin — New Indigenous Antibiotic

India has developed a new antibiotic named **Nafithromycin**, created to treat drug-resistant respiratory tract infections, addressing the growing challenge of antimicrobial resistance (AMR).

6. WHO — Five African Countries Declared Free of Type-2 Polio

The **World Health Organization (WHO)** announced that five African countries have become free of Type-2 poliovirus. Type-2 poliovirus mainly affects children under the age of five, potentially causing paralysis or death.

Countries declared Type-2 polio free	Burundi, Ghana, Guinea, Republic of Congo, Uganda
WHO formed on	7 April 1948
WHO Headquarters	Geneva, Switzerland
WHO Director-General	Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus
World Polio Day	24 October (observed by WHO)
Global Polio Eradication Initiative	Launched by WHO in 1988
India's polio-free status	Declared polio-free in 2014
India's related scheme	Mission Indradhanush (2019–20) — child vaccination programme, including polio

Related HQ locations (frequently asked): UNICEF — New York; World Bank & IMF — Washington D.C.; WHO — Geneva; UNESCO — Paris; UNDP — New York.

Note: In the discussion, a Commonwealth Games reference was also made to an Indian para-athlete who overcame childhood polio (at age 5) to win India's first medal (a bronze) at the Commonwealth Games — cited in class as Jhandu ji (para-athlete reference from the Commonwealth Games segment).

Quick Revision — One-Line Recap

- India's first Non-GMO popcorn maize launched in Andhra Pradesh (Musunuru, Eluru district) by ICAR + IIMR.
- Kavach = India's Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system; Kavach 4.0 recently launched; used in Vande Bharat.
- NSG (Black Cat Commandos) launched India's first All-Women Commando Course in Manesar, Haryana (12 weeks).
- NSG formed 16 October 1984, after Operation Blue Star; under Ministry of Home Affairs; HQ training centre in Gurugram.
- Chinook = Foehn-type wind of the Rocky Mountains, also called the 'Snow Eater'.
- Nafithromycin = new Indian antibiotic for drug-resistant respiratory tract infections.
- WHO declared 5 African nations (Burundi, Ghana, Guinea, Republic of Congo, Uganda) free of Type-2 polio.
- WHO: formed 1948, HQ Geneva, chief Dr. Tedros; World Polio Day observed 24 October.
- India declared polio-free in 2014; Mission Indradhanush is India's child-vaccination programme.
- Gurugram: host to Green ATM, LPG ATM, and HQ of the International Solar Alliance (only such HQ in India).

Practice MCQs — Based on Today's Current Affairs

Q1. India's first Non-GMO popcorn maize variety was launched in which state?

- (a) Telangana (b) Andhra Pradesh (c) Karnataka (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (b) Andhra Pradesh

Q2. Which two institutions jointly developed India's first Non-GMO popcorn maize variety?

- (a) ICAR and IIMR (b) DRDO and ISRO (c) ICMR and AIIMS (d) NITI Aayog and CSIR

Answer: (a) ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research) and IIMR (Indian Institute of Maize Research)

Q3. The headquarters of the Indian Institute of Maize Research (IIMR) is located in:

- (a) New Delhi (b) Ludhiana (c) Bhopal (d) Chennai

Answer: (b) Ludhiana

Q4. What is 'Kavach', recently in news?

- (a) A missile defence system (b) An Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system (c) A cybersecurity firewall for banks (d) A weather forecasting satellite

Answer: (b) An Automatic Train Protection (ATP) system

Q5. The National Security Guard (NSG) is popularly known as:

- (a) Grey Wolves (b) Black Cat Commandos (c) Red Tigers (d) Blue Berets

Answer: (b) Black Cat Commandos

Q6. NSG's first All-Women Commando Course was launched at which location?

- (a) Gurugram, Haryana (b) Manesar, Haryana (c) Chandigarh (d) Panchkula, Haryana

Answer: (b) Manesar, Haryana

Q7. The National Security Guard (NSG) was formed in the aftermath of which operation?

- (a) Operation Blue Star (b) Operation Vijay (c) Operation Cactus (d) Operation Meghdoot

Answer: (a) Operation Blue Star (NSG formed on 16 October 1984)

Q8. The Headquarters of the International Solar Alliance (ISA) is located in:

- (a) New Delhi (b) Gurugram (c) Geneva (d) Chandigarh

Answer: (b) Gurugram, Haryana

Q9. The 'Chinook', a Foehn-type wind associated with the Rocky Mountains, is also known as:

- (a) Snow Eater (b) Ice Melter (c) Warm Breeze (d) Mistral

Answer: (a) Snow Eater

Q10. Nafithromycin, an antibiotic developed in India, is primarily used to treat:

- (a) Drug-resistant urinary tract infections (b) Drug-resistant respiratory tract infections (c) Skin infections (d) Malaria

Answer: (b) Drug-resistant respiratory tract infections

Q11. Which organisation recently announced that five African countries are now free of Type-2 poliovirus?

- (a) UNICEF (b) World Bank (c) WHO (d) UNESCO

Answer: (c) WHO (World Health Organization)

Q12. The headquarters of the World Health Organization (WHO) is located in:

- (a) New York (b) Geneva (c) Paris (d) Washington D.C.

Answer: (b) Geneva

Q13. World Polio Day is observed annually on:

- (a) 10 October (b) 24 October (c) 5 November (d) 1 December

Answer: (b) 24 October

Q14. India was officially declared polio-free in which year?

- (a) 2010 (b) 2012 (c) 2014 (d) 2016

Answer: (c) 2014

Q15. Mission Indradhanush, associated with child vaccination in India, was expanded/launched in:

- (a) 2014-15 (b) 2019-20 (c) 2021-22 (d) 2023-24

Answer: (b) 2019-20